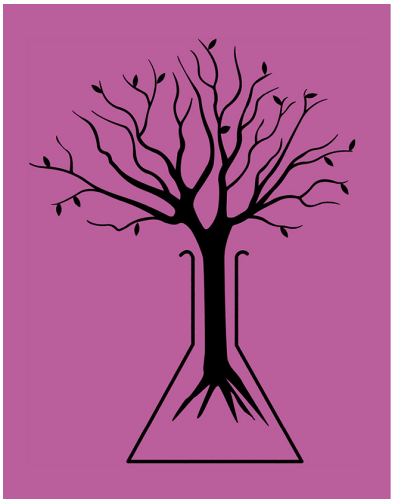


THE TIME HAS COME FOR SCIENCE TO BUSY ITSELF WITH THE EARTH

ENVIRONMENTAL ETHICS

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Aldo Leopold (1887–1948)

BEFORE

1894 In *The Mountains of California*, Scottish–American naturalist John Muir describes his travels through wild places in California, evoking the deep spirituality and adventure he feels when in the wilderness.

1909 Gifford Pinchot's *The ABC of Conservation* argues that future generations should be able to utilize Earth's natural resources.

AFTER

1968 US academic Paul R. Ehrlich and his wife, Anne, publish *The Population Bomb*, warning of the dangers of human population growth.

1970 On April 22, the first Earth Day is celebrated in the US. It becomes an annual global celebration of environmental education and reform.

At its heart, the discipline of environmental ethics extends the boundaries of ethics beyond humans, and into the natural world. It forces humans to question their role in the environment, their responsibility to the planet itself, and their duty to future generations.